

02 Action and state verbs

Verbs that describe actions or events are known as "action" or "dynamic" verbs, whereas those that describe states are known as "state" or "stative" verbs.

 **New language** State verbs in continuous forms

Aa Vocabulary Action and state verbs

 **New skill** Describing states

2.1 KEY LANGUAGE ACTION AND STATE VERBS

Action verbs can be used in simple and continuous forms.
State verbs are not usually used in continuous forms.

ACTION



I **read** every day. ✓

I **am reading** right now. ✓

STATE



I **own** two cars. ✓

I **am owning** two cars. ✗



2.2 KEY LANGUAGE USING STATE VERBS IN CONTINUOUS FORMS

Some verbs can be both action and state verbs. When these verbs are describing an action, they can be used in continuous forms.

ACTION



I **am thinking** about taking up fencing.
[Right now, I'm considering taking up fencing.]

STATE



I **think** fencing is a great sport.
[In my opinion, fencing is a great sport.]



The chef **is tasting** his soup.
[The chef is testing the soup's flavor.]



This soup **tastes** disgusting!
[The soup has a disgusting flavor.]

Other state verbs can be used in continuous forms. They keep their stative meaning, but emphasize a change, development, or temporary situation.

CONTINUOUS FORM



Are you **feeling** better today?
You **seemed** sick yesterday.



SIMPLE FORM

How do you **feel**
about Modern art?

